

GEOGRAPHY

PHYSICAL GEOGRAPHY



GEOMORPHOLOGY

MODULE - 21

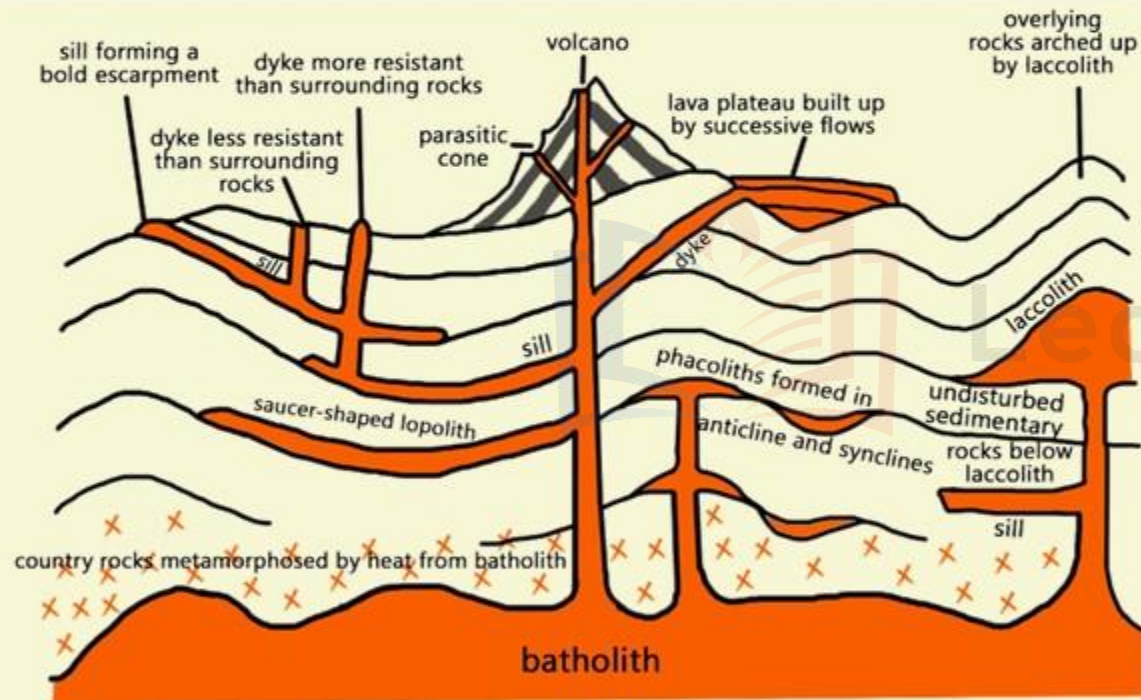
VOLCANOES

- **INTRUSIVE LANDFORMS**

VULCANISM AND VARIOUS FORMS

HOW VARIOUS LANDFORMS ARE FORMED?

- 1 Magma while thrusting its way up to the surface may cool and solidify within the crust as **plutonic rocks**. It results in **Intrusive Landforms**.
- 2 Magmas that **reach the surface** and solidify form **Extrusive Landforms**.



VULCANISM AND VARIOUS FORMS

INTRUSION

It forms features such as **dykes and sills**. It can intrude into a low density rock such as sedimentary rock and when it cools into solid rock this intrusion is called a **pluton**. A pluton is an intrusion of magma that wells up from below the surface and they can form intrusive landforms.

EXTRUSION

The most familiar way for magma to escape is through lava. Lava eruptions can be **fire fountains of liquid rock or thick slow moving rivers of molten material**. Lava cools to form volcanic rock as well as volcanic glass.

INTRUSIVE LANDFORMS

1

SILLS



1 The commonest intrusive landforms are **Sills and Dykes**.

2 When an **intrusion takes place horizontally** along the bedding plates of sedimentary rocks, it is known as **Sill**.

3 The denudation of the overlying sedimentary strata exposes the intrusion which will resemble a lava flow or form a bold escarpment.

INTRUSIVE LANDFORMS

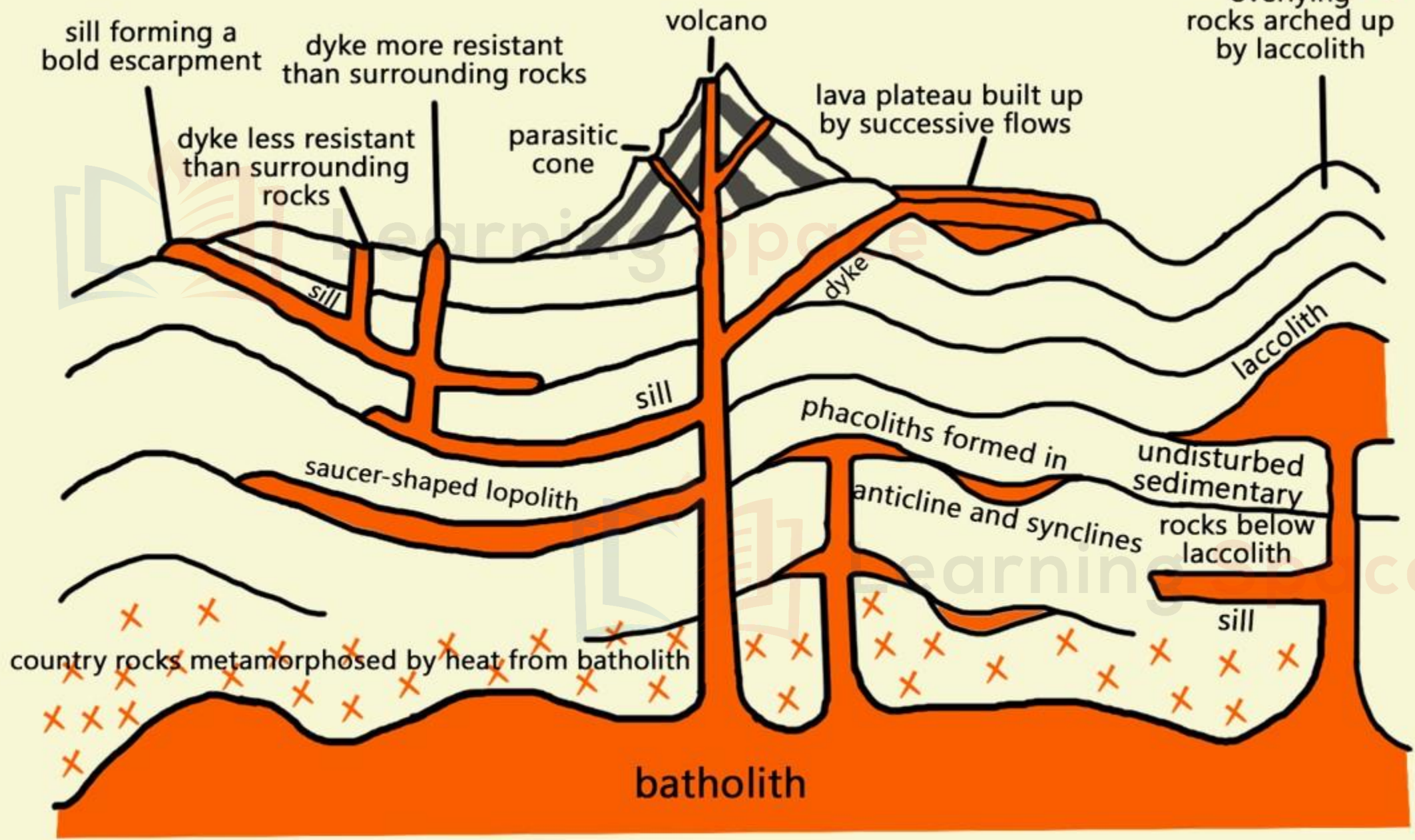
2 DYKES

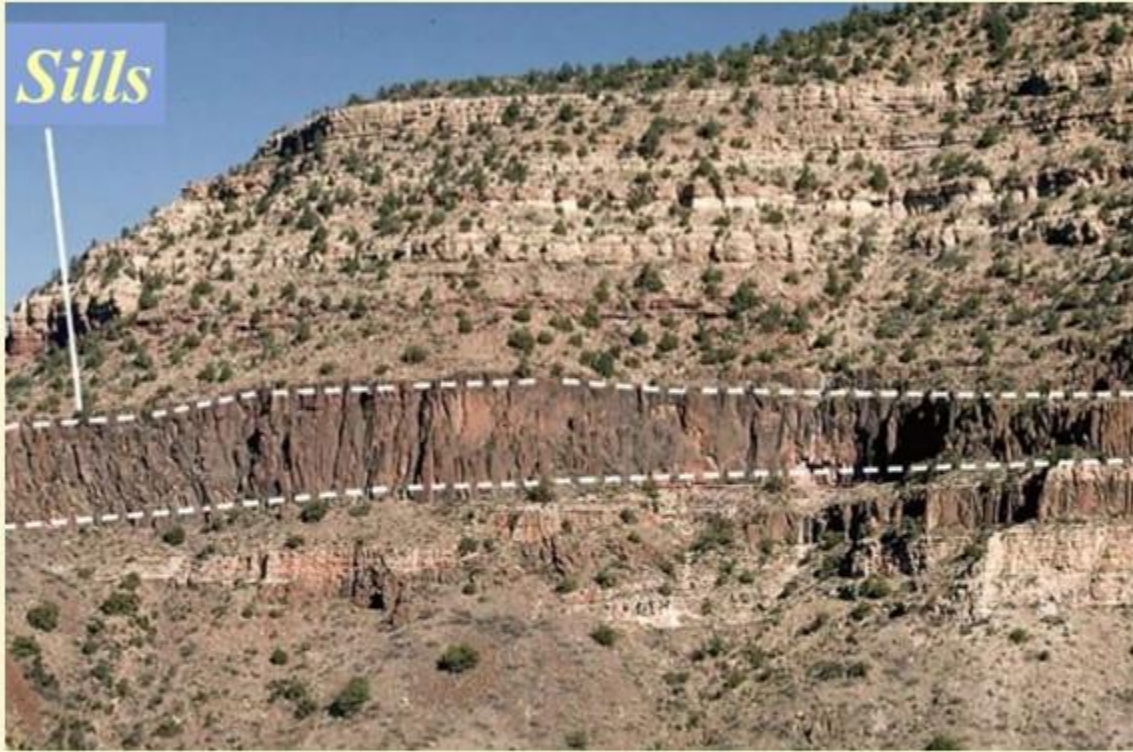


1 Similar **intrusions** when injected **vertically** as narrow walls of igneous rocks within the sedimentary layers are called Dykes.

2 **Because of their narrowness**, dykes seldom dominate the landscape.

3 When exposed to denudation, dykes may appear as **upstanding walls** or **shallow trenches**, depending on whether they are more or less resistant than the rocks in which they are placed.





SILLS



DYKES

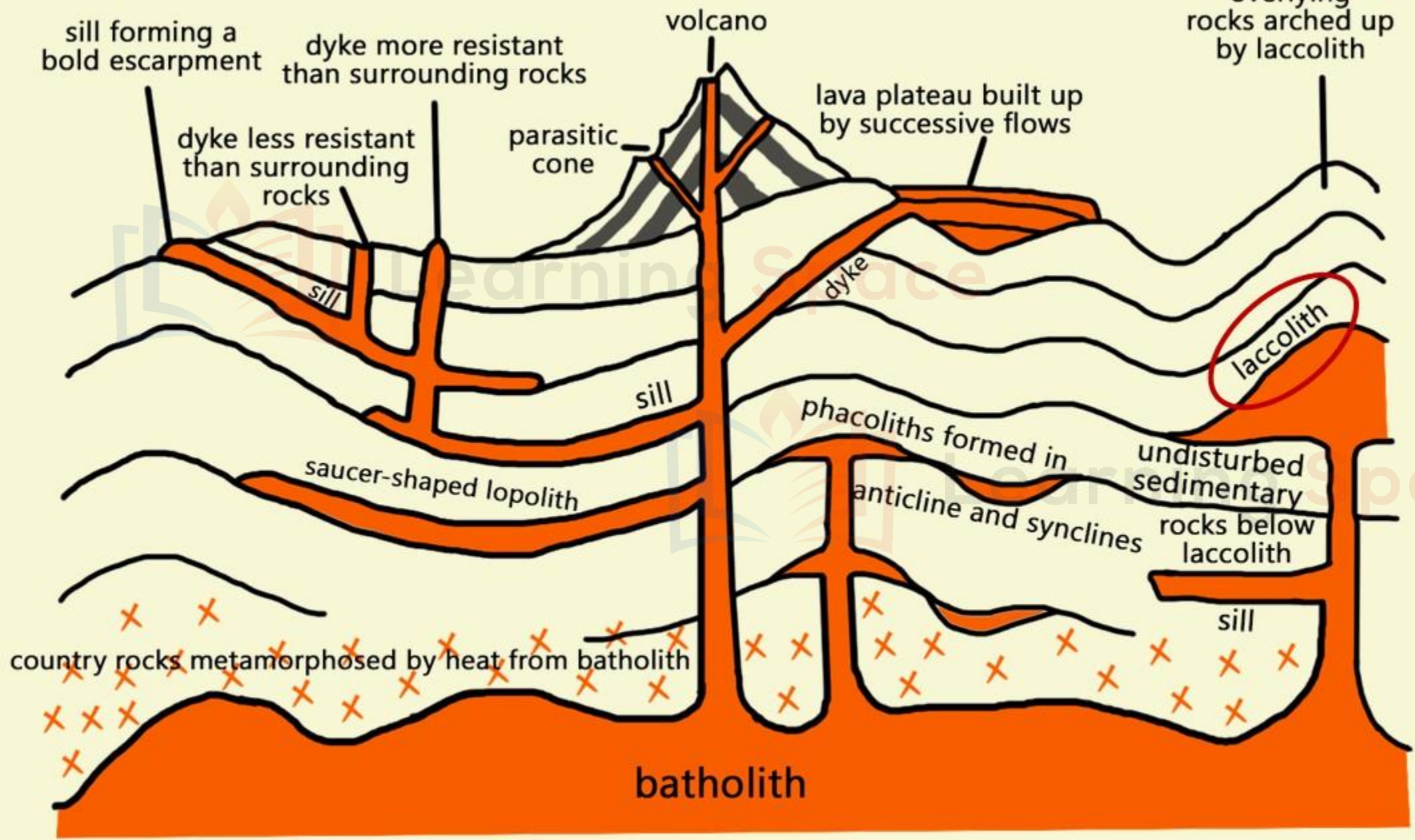
INTRUSIVE LANDFORMS

3 LACCOLITHS



Henry Mountains in Utah

- It is a large blister or igneous mound with a **dome-shaped upper surface** and a **level base** fed by a **pipe-like conduit** from below.
- It arches up the overlying strata of sedimentary rocks.
- Examples are laccoliths of Henry Mountains, in Utah, United States of America.





UNITED STATES

UTAH

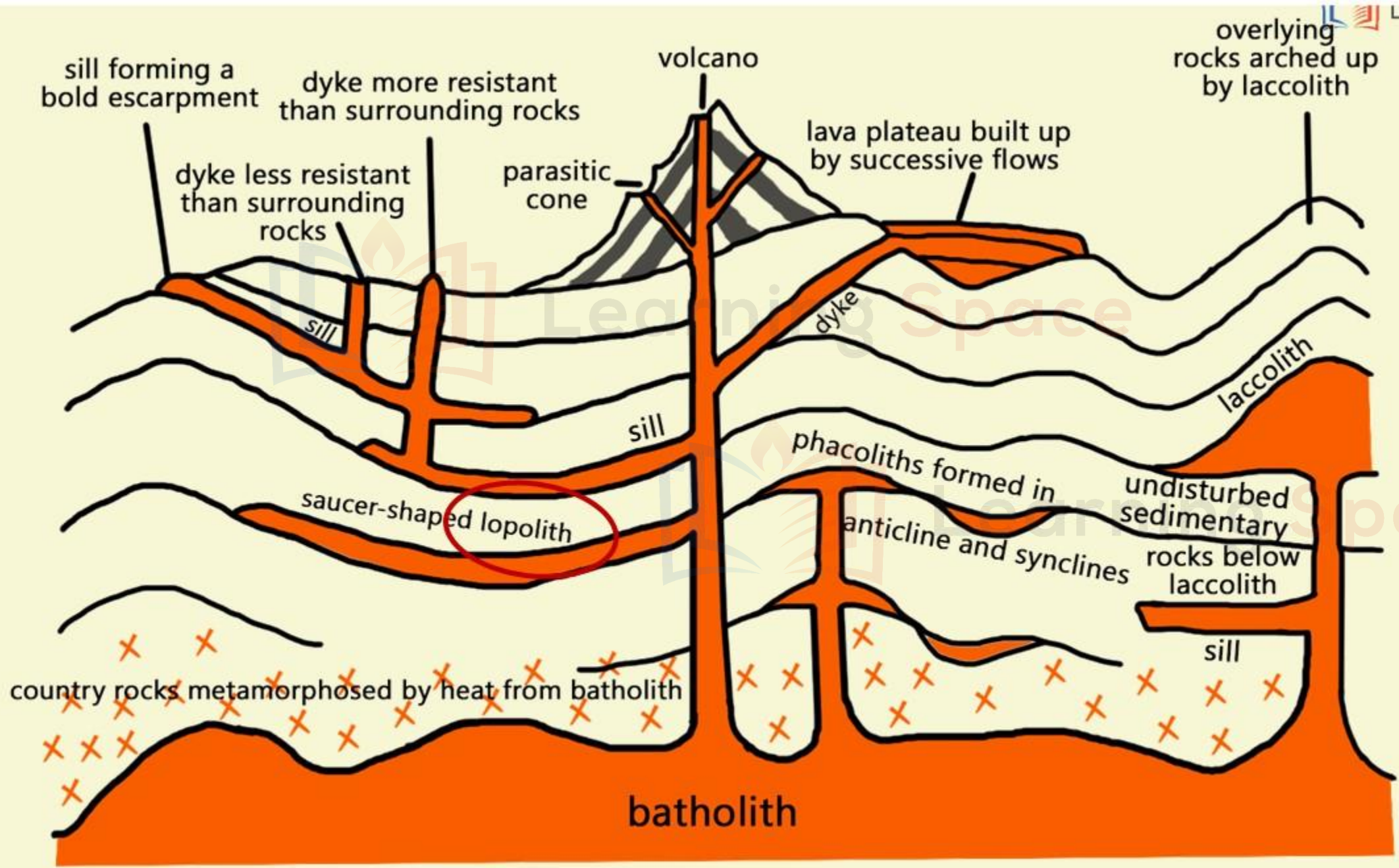
HENRY MOUNTAINS

NORTH
ATLANTIC OCEAN

NORTH
PACIFIC OCEAN

GULF OF MEXICO

MEXICO



INTRUSIVE LANDFORMS

4 LOPOLITH



The Bushveld lopolith in southern Africa is several hundred kilometres across and contains the richest platinum deposits known.

- It is another variety of igneous intrusion with a saucer shape.
- A shallow basin is formed in the mid of the country rocks.
- The Bushveld lopoliths of Transvaal, South Africa are good examples.

NAMIBIA

BOTSWANA

BUSHVELD LOPOLITHS

TRANSVAAL

LESOTHO

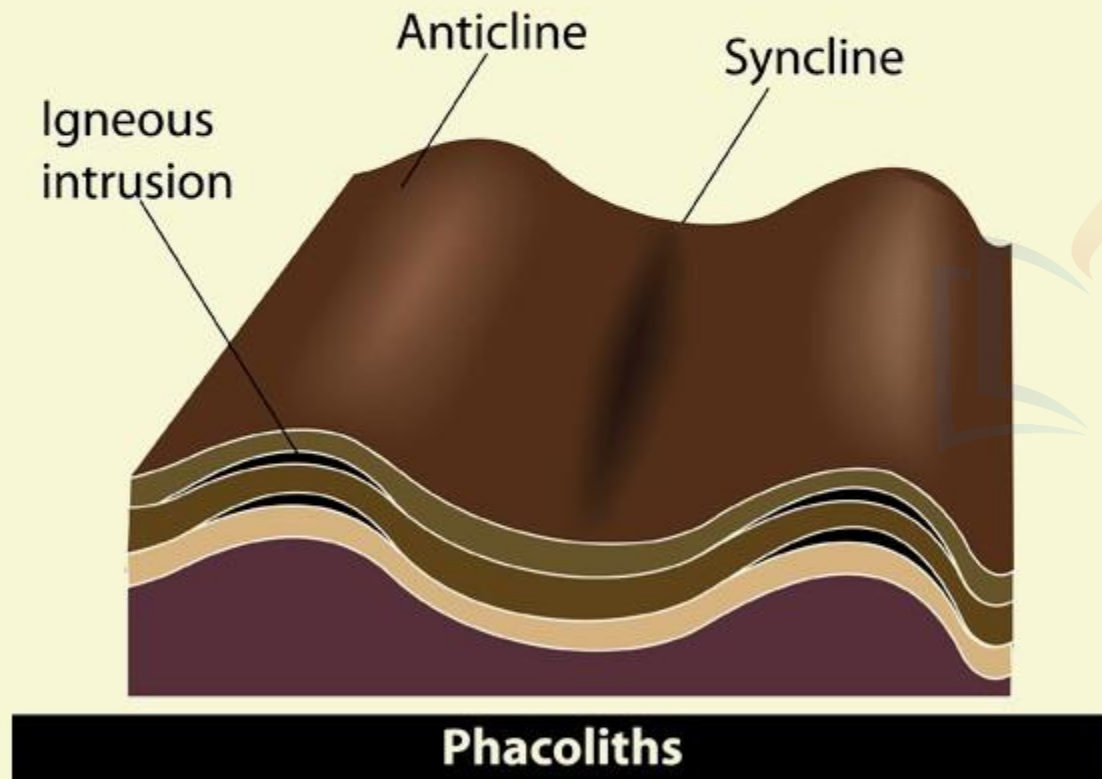
SOUTH AFRICA

INDIAN OCEAN

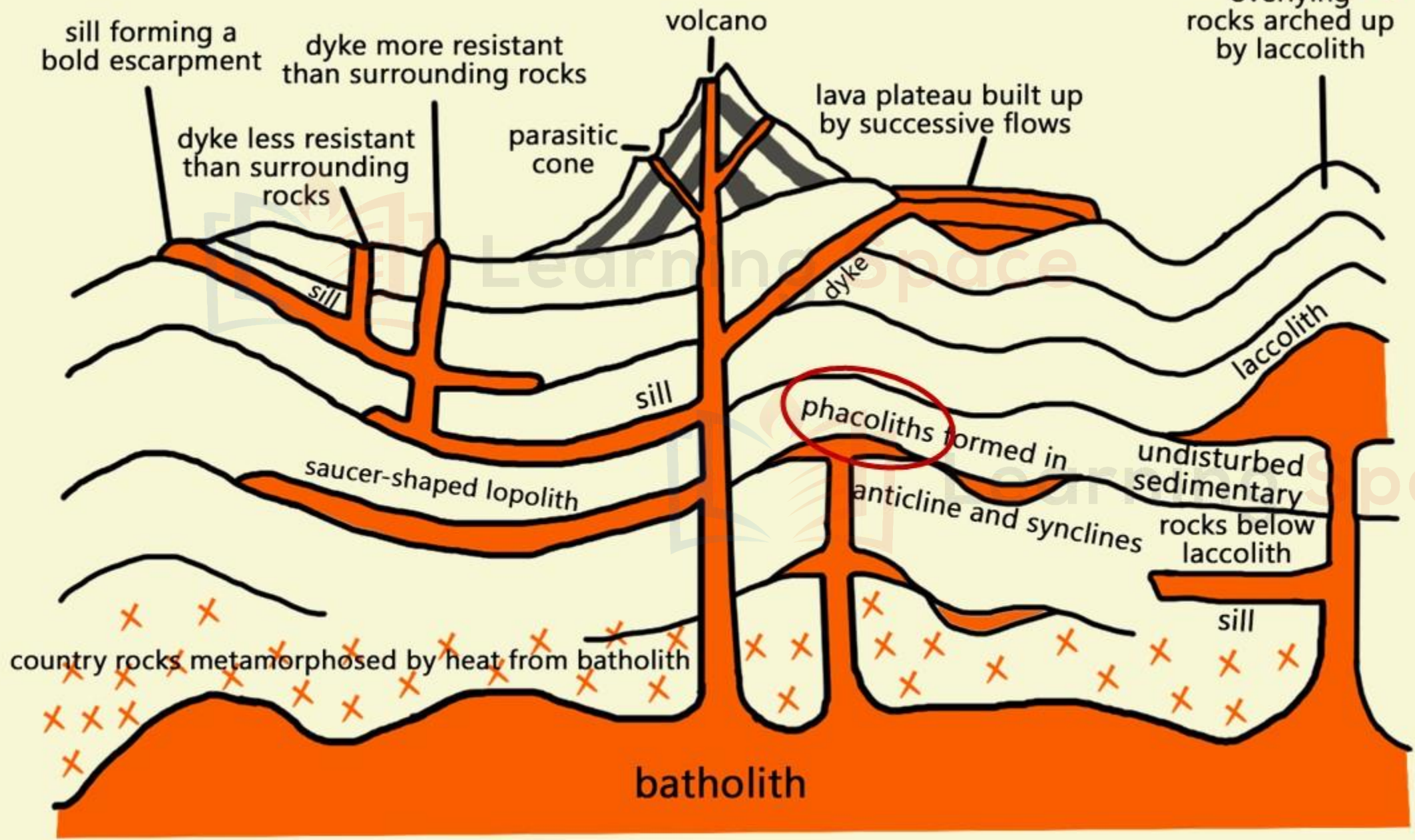


INTRUSIVE LANDFORMS

5 PHACOLITH



- It is a **lens-shaped mass of igneous rocks** occupying the crest of an anticline or the bottom of a syncline and being fed by a conduit from beneath.
- Example is Corndon Hill in Shropshire, England.



*North
Atlantic
Ocean*

North Sea

SCOTLAND

NORTHERN
IRELAND

Corndon Hill

Shropshire

IRELAND

England

WALES

NETHERLANDS

BELGIUM

GERMANY



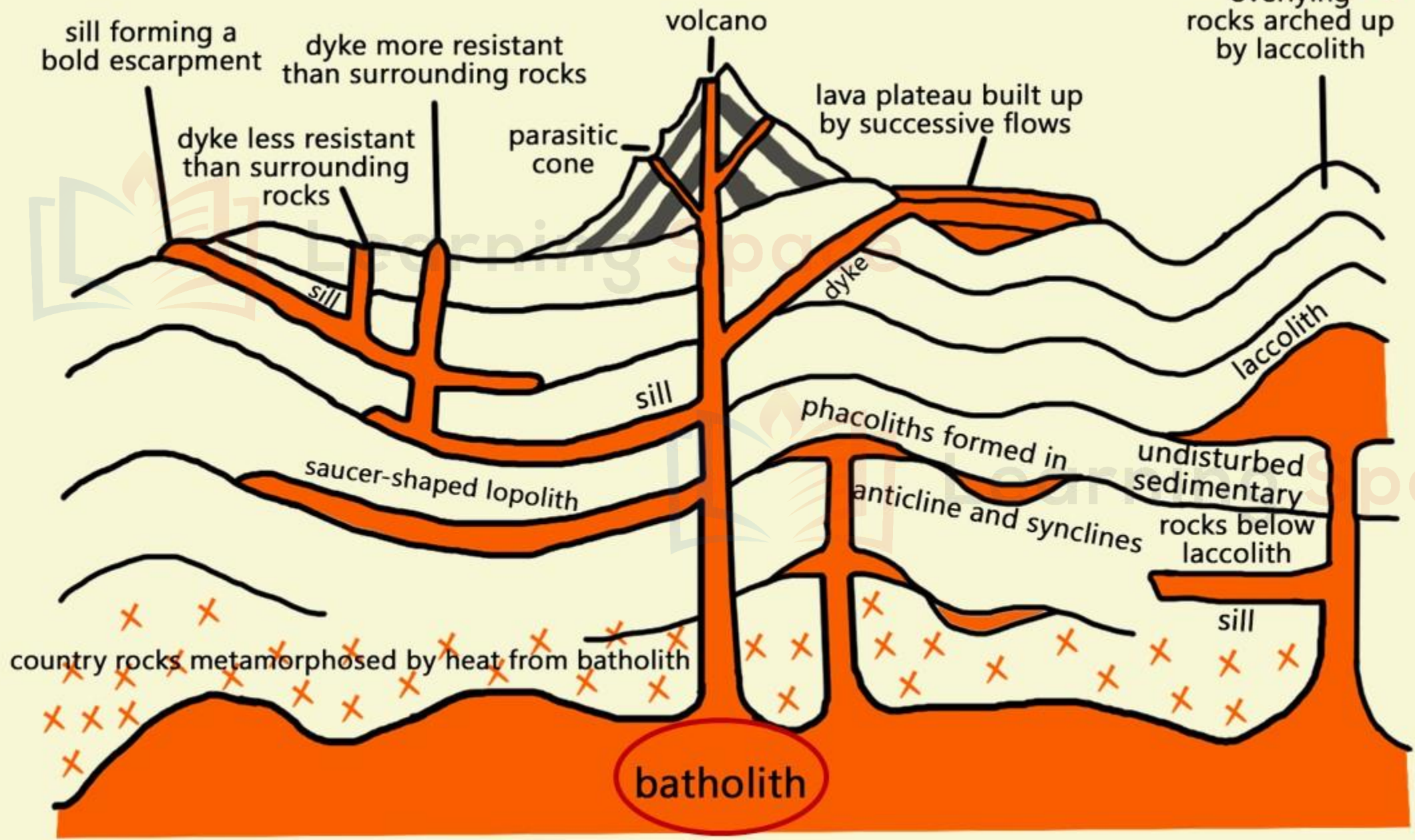
INTRUSIVE LANDFORMS

6 BATHOLITH



Exposed Sierra Nevada Batholith

- It is a **huge mass of igneous rocks**, usually granite, which after removal of the overlying rocks form a **massive and resistant upland region**.
- Examples are Wicklow Mountains of Ireland, Uplands of Brittany, France and Main Range of West Malaysia.
- Their precise mode of origin is still a matter of controversy.
- It is generally believed that **large masses of magma rising upwards metamorphosed the country rocks** with which they came into contact.
- These **metamorphosed rocks together with solidified magma gave rise to extensive batholiths**.
- They are sometimes hundreds of kilometres in extent.
- They are more spectacular of the intrusive landform.



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